

WOMEN OUTSHINE MEN ON THE MAT, PROVIDE GLIMPSE INTO FUTURE

The WFI **needs to support** promising women wrestlers and focus more on men's freestyle wrestling to enhance the country's chances of winning medals in future Olympic Games.

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Indian women wrestlers continued their impressive ascent by breaking Japan's dominance and clinching the team title at the Princess Sumaya Bint al-Hasan Arena in the World Under-17 Championships in Amman, Jordan, for the first time.

With a stellar performance, the Indian team secured five gold, one silver, and two bronze medals, amassing 185 points — 39 points ahead of Japan and 106 ahead of Kazakhstan. This remarkable achievement signals a promising future for Indian women's wrestling, especially as the country looks forward to the upcoming Olympics.

Notably, this victory follows India's maiden triumph in the World U-20 Championships in Amman the previous year.

India, which has consistently finished in the top five of the World

U-17 women's wrestling event over the past five years, had previously secured second place behind the USA in 2021 (when Japan did not participate) and Japan in 2022.

The Indian men, however, had a less successful tournament. Two Greco-Roman wrestlers won bronze medals, while the freestyle wrestlers, who are traditionally stronger in the country, returned empty-handed from Amman.

In the women's categories, Aditi Kumari (43kg), Neha Sangwan (57kg), Pulkit Kandola (65kg), Kajal (69kg), and Mansi Lather (73kg) each won gold medals. Shrutika Patil (46kg) earned a silver medal, and Bala Raj (40kg) and Muskan (53kg) secured bronze medals.

Hailing from Daulatabad, 16-year-old Aditi, an Asian U-15 silver medallist in the 46kg category last year, elevated her performance to

compete successfully in a higher age group.

Under the guidance of her father, Swapan Janghu, a former state-level wrestler, and coach Pradeep Malik, Aditi showcased her dominance with commanding victories, including a notable quarterfinal win against Egyptian Mareim Ahmed.

Neha, a former Asian U-15 and U-17 champion who grew up in a wrestling family, surpassed her bronze medal finish in 2023. She defeated Japanese wrestler So Tsutsui 10-0 in the final through technical superiority, just days after

Dominance personified: India won 10 medals, including five gold medals, at the 2024 U-17 World Wrestling Championships, with women claiming eight of the 10.

SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT